Technical Portfolio Reflective Report

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Introduction to Computer Programming Using Python

Creating my technical portfolio gave me a chance to look back at the Python work I completed during the course and see how my programming skills developed. At the beginning, many of the exercises were focused on individual concepts. When I collected the projects in one portfolio, I could see how topics such as functions, strings, tuples, data structures, file handling, and databases connect to each other in larger programs.

One part of the process was selecting projects that showed different skills instead of uploading very similar examples. I included several lab projects and my mid-term project because they represent different stages of my learning. I also created a Treasure Hunt game as an additional project. The game uses user input, decisions, functions, and different paths depending on the player's choices. Testing the different choices was useful because I had to make sure that each path produced the expected result and that the program ended correctly.

I also learned more about presenting technical work online. I uploaded my Python files to GitHub and then connected them to my Clippings.me portfolio. Before this assignment, I mainly thought of GitHub as a place to store code. During this project, I saw how it can also be used to show programming work in an organized way. Writing short descriptions for each project was helpful because I had to explain what the program does without simply showing the source code.

Another part of the portfolio was choosing Python resources that were related to my work. I selected official Python documentation about errors and exceptions, data structures, and defining functions. These topics were useful because they connect directly with problems and concepts I worked with during the course. For example, learning more about errors and exceptions can make debugging easier, while the sections about data structures and functions helped reinforce concepts I used in my programs (Python Software Foundation, n.d.-a, n.d.-b, n.d.-c).

Overall, this assignment helped me see my progress more clearly. My earlier programs were smaller and focused on one concept, while later work required me to combine several ideas and test more possibilities. The portfolio is useful because I can continue adding projects as I learn new programming skills. It also gave me more practice with GitHub, documentation, testing, and explaining my own code, which are skills I can use in future courses and projects.

References

Python Software Foundation. (n.d.-a). *Errors and exceptions.* Python documentation. https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/errors.html

Python Software Foundation. (n.d.-b). *Data structures.* Python documentation. https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/datastructures.html

Python Software Foundation. (n.d.-c). *More control flow tools.* Python documentation. https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/controlflow.html